

Brother HL-2130

Worthy compact laser printer

The Brother HL-2130 laser printer is Brother's entry-level monochromatic laser printer. Being an entry-level model this printer doesn't pack a lot of features. One of its main highlights is the presence of a 250-sheet tray in spite of its compact size. The printer also sees a manual feed slot for odd paper sizes and for envelopes. Being an entry-level printer there is no inbuilt Wi-Fi or Ethernet port. There is also no memory card reader and neither a duplexer.

It has a cube shaped form factor. The grey tone of the printer gives it a corporate feel all over. The design is very minimalist, we like it. On the top, you find 3 LED indicators one

each for the toner and drum error and the last one for general errors. Removal of the paper load tray is very smooth and so is the removal of the toner and drum. Overall the build quality is decent, though, the build quality of the paper load tray is very rickety. Though we like the compact design, we wish the build quality was more robust and sturdy.

The printer printed our text test sheet in 12.12 secs at 1200 dpi. When set at 300 dpi, it managed to print five text test sheets in 22.33secs, that's quite



fast. In our image plus text test, the printer threw out the print in 18.19 secs set at 1200 dpi. Overall the speeds at which the prints came out was very good.

The pricing is decent for someone looking at a fast monochrome printer, although we would like to see it dip further.

Aniruddh Subramanian

Specifications

Processor: 200 MHz ARM9

Memory: 8 MB

Resolution supported:

1,200/600/300 dpi

Toner [TN-2060]:

700 pages claimed

Drum [DR-2255]:

12,000 pages claimed

Contact

Brother International Pvt Ltd

Email: Rishikesh.Kane@

brother.in

Contact: 022-40988900

Web site: www.brother.in

Price: ₹5,290

7.5
10

Features	7.0
Performance.....	8.0
Build Quality	7.5
Value for Money	8.0

Bulldozer AMD FX-8150

Doesn't quite bulldoze the competition

Specifications

No. of cores: 8;

Clock Speed: 3.6 GHz;

Transistor count: 2 billion;

Manufacturing Process: 32nm;

L2 cache: 8 MB

Contact

AMD

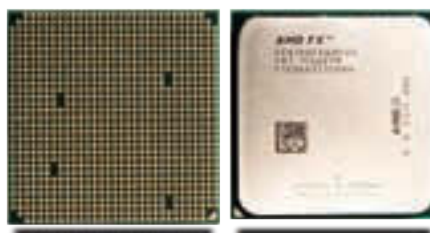
Web site: www.amd.com

Price: ₹15,500

The AMD FX-8150 is based on the 32nm manufacturing process

and has around two billion transistors. You'll need a Socket AM3+ motherboard for running the Bulldozer. It features the Turbo Core with some minor additions – for applications using say 3 of the 8 cores, Max Turbo will increase the clock speed on these 3 cores. Max Turbo Core can go upto 4.2GHz depending on the thermal headroom.

Performance-wise, we were not very impressed with Bulldozer. While it's certainly way better than the Llano chips, we can't say the same for the Phenom II X6 processors. The Intel Core i7-2600K still



is faster than FX-8150, despite the latter having eight cores compared to the former's four cores.

In Cinebench R11.5, the FX-8150 gave 5.96 as opposed to 2600K's 6.86 and 2500K's 6.16. DivX encoding took roughly the same time as was taken on the older Phenom II X6 1075T – around 26 seconds; whereas the 2600K would finish the same task under 20 seconds.

We indulged in minor over-

clocking over the air and got the FX-8150 running at a steady 4.4GHz. Cinebench R11.5 kept crashing, but we got over 1,000-point jump in the Cinebench R10 readings. With voltage tweaking and liquid cooling you can easily cross 5 GHz.

At ₹15,500, we'd rather wait and see how the other FX series processors perform and how much of a boost the 8150 offers. For everyday desktop applications, eight cores are overkill. As for competition, FX-8150 lags behind Intel Core i7-2600K in all the tests and i5-2500K in some tests, and the pricing is over 2500K. As far as AMD goes, the FX-8150 is the best processor yet.

Nimish Sawant

6.5
10

Features	7.0
Performance.....	6.5
Value for Money	6.0